

SQL VIEWS CLASSIFICATION

A visual breakdown of virtual tables, materialized views, and subquery concepts in SQL

SQL Views

Non-Materialized Views

(Regular / Virtual Views)

Simple View

- One table
- No joins
- No GROUP BY
- No aggregates
- Usually updatable

Complex View

- Multiple tables
- Joins
- GROUP BY
- Aggregates
- Usually read-only

Inline View

(Special Case)

- Subquery in FROM clause
- Temporary
- Exists only during query execution
- Not created using CREATE VIEW
- Similar purpose as a CTE (WITH)

Materialized Views

(Physically Stored Views)

- Stores query result on disk
- Faster reads
- Needs REFRESH
- Used for reporting / analytics